



Guidelines For Use Of IAF Test Facilities By Private Entities

Extending the usage of Indian Air Force (IAF) test facilities, including aviation assets to private sectors/entities, would boost the indigenous aviation defence industry, thereby reducing dependence on foreign suppliers. These guidelines aim to outline the modalities for the use of IAF assets (testing and evaluation establishments, labs, ranges, aircraft, helicopters, radars, and ground equipment) by the private sector to test equipment and systems being designed and developed to meet IAF requirements. The test facilities/assets would be provided for use by the private sector when not in use by the IAF. However, IAF reserves the right to change the time slot, or deny usage of the test facilities due to operational, security, or weather reasons.

Test facilities with IAF. IAF has specialised establishments dedicated to test aviation equipment and systems. Apart from these, various air to ground/small arms ranges, aircraft, helicopters, radars, and other ground equipment required for testing purposes could be sourced by private entities for testing and evaluation of equipment and systems developed by them for defence applications.

Procedure. The following procedure is used for availing IAF test facilities/assets by the Indian private sector/entity:

Testing coordination cell (TCC) has been set up at Air HQ under the deputy chief of air staff (DCAS). TCC is the single point of contact between the private entities and IAF test establishments/facilities. The main tasks of TCC are to:

1. Maintain and update the approved list of test facilities and assets that can be offered to private entities from time to time on the Ministry of Defence (MoD) and IAF websites.

2. Expediently action the request submitted by private entities.

3. Coordinate/facilitate discussion between IAF testing agencies and private entities as required.

4. Allot time slots/assets for testing and evaluation by the private sector with due approval of the DCAS.

5. Work out testing modalities in consultation with IAF test centres and private entities.

6. Work out the cost of testing, taking into account the approved usage rates of assets and facilities being utilised, likely usage of consumables, and other associated costs, in consultation with the private sector. A memorandum of understanding (MoU)/agreement will be signed that stipulates the terms and conditions, including payment terms by the private sector and indemnities to safeguard the interests of the government of India.

7. Coordinate security clearances of private entities interested in testing their equipment at IAF establishments.

8. Prepare a detailed task directive for conducting trials.

Approval for utilisation of IAF test facilities/assets. On receipt of a request from private entities, the nodal officer at TCC will ascertain that the system/equipment to be tested using the IAF facility has been developed for meeting the IAF requirement. The officer will ascertain the availability of test facilities/assets and seek approval of the DCAS for conducting trials using IAF test facilities/assets.

Trial and evaluation, cost of testing, non-disclosure agreement. Certain tests may require modification of the platform. Such modifications, if deemed unsuitable by the IAF, will be denied. Further, the private sector/entity will bear the cost of any modification and de-modification that may be required for carrying out testing. Such modifications will be carried out only by authorised agencies, following due clearances and certifications.

A trial coordination meeting will be conducted at Air HQ or on-site to formulate a trial directive. The meeting is to be attended by all stakeholders. Subsequently, TCC will issue a trial directive duly approved by the DCAS, addressing all issues related to trials and exercise command and control over the conduct of trials. The TCC, on the conclusion of trials, will settle the final bill with the private sector/entity.

The approved rates of usage of IAF assets, as available with Directorate of Financial Planning, shall be used as a basis of all cost calculations. The cost of carrying out test procedures will be calculated on a case to case basis and approved by the DCAS.

Adequate safeguards are to be incorporated so as to avoid any leakage of information by private entities and vice versa. Therefore these entities are required to sign a non-disclosure agreement with all stakeholders, which prohibits the sharing of information with regards to testing equipment with any other agency.

Accident coverage and indemnity bond. The private sector cannot claim any compensation from IAF/MoD. However, damage to service property due to negligence on the part of the private sector would be paid in full by them. Damage to government properties not attributable to the private sector would be written off against loss to the government of India (GoI). Air force personnel involved in testing and evaluation would get immunity in case the equipment of the private sector gets damaged during the process of testing and evaluation. The participants of the private sector would also sign the indemnity bond to absolve the IAF/GoI of any damage/harm caused to them during the process of trials and evaluation. **EFY**

Source: <https://indianairforce.nic.in>